Side Hustle Starter Kit

30 zero-cost side hustles · 7-day launch plan · pricing cheat sheet · outreach scripts

EasyMoney · 2026 edition
Information only. Not financial, legal or tax advice. No income guarantees.

How to use this kit (5 minutes)

1. **Skim the 30-hustle table** (pages 3–4). Star any idea you could do this week with what you already own.
2. **Score your stars** with the "Pick one in 10 minutes" worksheet (page 5). Pick the top score. Do not overthink — you can switch later.
3. **Price it** with the cheat sheet (page 6).
4. **Follow the 7-day checklist** (page 7). One task a day. Each takes 20–60 minutes.
5. **Use the scripts** (page 8) to send your first 10 offers. Most first dollars come from people who already know you.

The rule of first dollars: your first customer is almost never a stranger on the internet. It's a neighbor, a friend's small business, a coworker, or someone in a local group. Start there, then go online.

Keep it legal and safe: check local rules for any licensed work (food, childcare, driving, electrical). Meet strangers in public. Get paid before or on delivery through a payment app with buyer/seller protection. Track income for taxes from day one.

The 30 zero-cost side hustles (1/2)

#	Hustle	Who pays	Typical starter rate (US)	First step	Time to first $
1	Pet sitting / dog walking	Busy neighbors	$15–25 per walk	Post in neighborhood group	1–7 days
2	House sitting / plant watering	Travelers	$20–40/day	Tell 10 neighbors	1–3 weeks
3	Yard cleanup / leaf raking	Homeowners	$25–50/hr	Door-hang flyer, 20 homes	1–7 days
4	Furniture assembly	Movers, renters	$30–60 per item	Offer to 5 friends first	1–2 weeks
5	Garage / closet organizing	Families	$25–45/hr	Before/after photos of your own	1–2 weeks
6	Car interior cleaning	Commuters	$40–100 per car	Do one for a friend, take photos	1–7 days
7	Tutoring (school subjects)	Parents	$20–50/hr	Message parent groups	1–2 weeks
8	Music / language lessons	Adults, kids	$25–60/hr	Free 15-min trial offer	1–3 weeks
9	Tech help for seniors	Seniors, their kids	$25–50/hr	Flyer at library / community center	1–2 weeks
10	Resell free/curbside items	Marketplace buyers	$10–200 per item	Check "free" listings daily	1–5 days
11	Declutter & sell for others (consignment)	Downsizers	20–40% of sale	Offer to family first	1–2 weeks
12	Errand running / grocery pickup	Busy parents, seniors	$15–25/hr + gas	Post in local groups	1–7 days
13	Event help (setup, serving, cleanup)	Party hosts	$18–30/hr	Tell friends you're available	1–3 weeks
14	Babysitting (where permitted)	Parents	$15–25/hr	CPR course boosts trust	1–2 weeks
15	Snow shoveling (seasonal)	Homeowners	$25–75 per driveway	Knock after first forecast	Same day

The 30 zero-cost side hustles (2/2)

#	Hustle	Who pays	Typical starter rate (US)	First step	Time to first $
16	Social media posting for local shops	Small businesses	$150–400/mo	Make 3 sample posts for one shop	2–4 weeks
17	Google Business profile setup	Local businesses	$50–150 one-time	Find shops with incomplete profiles	1–2 weeks
18	Proofreading / editing	Students, writers	$15–35/hr	List on freelance marketplace	1–3 weeks
19	Resume & LinkedIn refresh	Job seekers	$40–120 per resume	Do 2 free for portfolio	1–2 weeks
20	Simple website for a local business	Small businesses	$200–600	Free site builder demo	2–4 weeks
21	Photo editing / background removal	Online sellers	$1–5 per photo	Offer batch of 20	1–2 weeks
22	Short-video editing	Creators, coaches	$25–75 per video	Edit a sample from public clips you own	1–3 weeks
23	Spreadsheet cleanup / templates	Small businesses	$25–50/hr	Ask a friend's business what's messy	1–2 weeks
24	Virtual assistant (email, scheduling)	Solo founders	$15–30/hr	Offer 5 hrs trial	1–3 weeks
25	Transcription / captions	Podcasters	$1–2 per audio minute	Free tools + careful proofing	1–2 weeks
26	Sell printables / templates	Online buyers	$1–10 each	Make 1 planner page, list it	1–4 weeks
27	User testing websites/apps	Testing platforms	$5–15 per test	Sign up on 2 platforms	1–2 weeks
28	Paid surveys & research studies	Research firms	$1–100 per study	Use reputable panels only	Days
29	Translation (if bilingual)	Businesses, individuals	$0.06–0.15 per word	Translate a sample page	1–3 weeks
30	Cooking/meal prep lessons (not selling food)	Busy adults	$25–50/hr	Host a 2-person session	1–3 weeks

Rates are rough US starter ranges seen on common marketplaces; your area may differ. Use them as a starting point, not a promise.

"Pick one in 10 minutes" worksheet

Score each starred idea 1–5 on each question. Highest total wins.

Idea	I can start this week	I already own what's needed	I know 5 people who'd want it	I'd enjoy doing it 10 times	Total

Tie-breaker: pick the one with the fastest "time to first $". Speed builds confidence; you can upgrade later.

My pick: _____ **My starter price:** _____ **Start date:** _____

Pricing cheat sheet

Minimum hourly rate = (monthly income goal + monthly costs) ÷ (hours per week × 4.33 × 0.6)
The 0.6 accounts for unpaid time: finding clients, travel, messages, admin.
Example: ($1,000 + $50) ÷ (8 × 4.33 × 0.6) ≈ **$51/hr**. If that's above market, raise hours or lower the goal — don't just work for less.

- **Price by the job when you can.** "Garage organized, $150" sells better than "$30/hr".
- **Offer three options.** Basic / Standard / Premium. Most people pick the middle.
- **First 3 customers:** a "launch price" 20% off is fine — say it's a launch price and say when it ends.
- **Raise prices** after 5 happy customers or when you're booked more than 2 weeks out.
- **Fees:** payment apps and marketplaces take a cut (often 3–20%). Add it to your price.
- **Taxes:** set aside 20–30% of profit. Keep every receipt.

Package	Example (dog walking)	Example (social media for a shop)
Basic	1 × 30-min walk — $20	8 posts/mo — $150
Standard	5 walks/week — $90	12 posts + stories — $250
Premium	5 walks + feeding + photos — $125	12 posts + replies + monthly report — $400

7-day launch checklist

☐ **Day 1 — Pick.** Fill out the worksheet. Choose one hustle and a starter price. (20 min)

☐ **Day 2 — Proof.** Create 1–3 samples: a before/after photo, a sample post, a mini portfolio, or a free job for a friend. (60 min)

☐ **Day 3 — Offer.** Write one sentence: "I help [who] get [result] for [price]." Make a simple flyer or post. (30 min)

☐ **Day 4 — Get paid set-up.** Set up a payment app, a separate notes/spreadsheet for income, and a calendar for bookings. (30 min)

☐ **Day 5 — Warm outreach.** Send Script A to 10 people you know. Ask for work or a referral. (45 min)

☐ **Day 6 — Go local/online.** Post in 2 local groups and list on 1 free marketplace (Script C). (45 min)

☐ **Day 7 — Follow up & review.** Send the follow-up to everyone who didn't answer. Write down: messages sent, replies, bookings. Adjust price or pitch. (30 min)

Goal for week 1: 20 offers sent, 1 paid job. That's a win. Repeat days 5–7 every week.

Copy-paste outreach scripts

Script A — friends & family
Hey [name]! I'm starting a small [service] side business — [one-line offer] for [price]. Do you or anyone you know need this in the next couple of weeks? A referral would mean a lot.

Script B — local business (in person or DM)
Hi [owner], I'm [name], local to [area]. I noticed [specific thing, e.g. "your last post was in March"]. I help shops like yours with [result]. I made 3 sample [posts/photos] for you — want me to send them? Starter price is [price], no long contract.

Script C — marketplace / community group post
[Service] in [area] — [price]. ✔ [benefit 1] ✔ [benefit 2] ✔ [reviews/references available]. Booking this week: [days]. Message me to reserve a spot.

Script D — after a finished job
Thanks again, [name]! If you were happy, would you mind leaving a quick review or passing my name to one friend? I'm offering [small thank-you] for referrals.

Follow-up (3 days later)
Hi [name], just bumping this in case it got buried — still have [2] spots open this week for [service]. No worries if not!

Where to list your offer for free

- **Local:** neighborhood apps and groups, community bulletin boards (library, laundromat, coffee shop), local Facebook groups, Craigslist services.
- **Freelance marketplaces:** general freelance sites for writing, editing, VA, design and video work.
- **Task apps:** errand, assembly and moving-help platforms in your city.
- **Digital products:** creator storefronts and print-on-demand / printable marketplaces.
- **Your own link:** a one-page site or link-in-bio with your offer, price and a payment link.

Weekly scoreboard
Offers sent: ____ Replies: ____ Booked: ____ Earned: $____ Next week's change: _____

Thanks for buying. Questions or refund requests: reply to your receipt within 14 days.
© 2026 EasyMoney. Personal use license — please don't redistribute.